

Step 1 : Is the patient at risk of malnutrition?

- Weigh patient, obtain height and calculate BMI. Obtain weight history over the last 6 months if possible and calculate MUST score [\[LINK\]](#)

Step 2 : Assess for underlying cause

- **Disease, disorder or medical condition** – provide disease related advice; treat nausea, vomiting, constipation; consider pain management; consider side effects of medication impacting appetite; consider if patient is following inappropriate restrictive dietary advice
- **Social** - access to food/shopping/food banks; family involvement; treat anxiety/depression & refer to appropriate services; consider referral to social prescriber/social groups/occupational therapy
- **Dental** – ensure good oral hygiene; advise on dental care; consider referral to dentist

Step 3 : Set clear treatment goals with patient

Goals may include:

- Wound healing – review wound severity/size before & after intervention
- To improve or maintain nutritional status/weight – review weight & MUST score before and after intervention
- To improve or maintain functional ability/quality of life

Step 4 : Optimise oral intake and provide food fortification advice

MUST1-2: Follow first line advice and review in 1 month

MUST 3+: **Seek dietetic advice prior to considering prescribing ONS.**

First line prescribing guidelines may not be appropriate for some patient groups such as those with swallowing difficulties, complex nutritional needs, renal disease/dialysis, gastrointestinal disorders, uncontrolled diabetes, decompensated liver disease or those patients approaching end of life. In these cases, consider referral to specialist services e.g. dietetics, speech and language therapy etc.

ONLY TO BE PRESCRIBED UNDER SUPERVISION OR ADVICE FROM DIETITIAN**First Line**

- **Food fortification advice and/or**
- **Over the counter ONS products**

Patients should be advised to fortify their food and have nutritious snacks and drinks.

Guidance for this is available [here](#) and can be shared with patients or carers.

Over the counter ONS products such as shakes and soups may be used, brands include:

- Complan
- Meritene

Second Line

- **Powder ONS**

Patients should be advised to fortify their food and have nutritious snacks and drinks. Guidance for this is available [here](#) and can be shared with patients or carers.

Alongside this patients should be prescribed powder ONS. **Recommended dose: 1 – 2 sachets per day.** Use links below to order sample packs.

Brands include:

Foodlink Complete [\[Link\]](#)
Aymes Shake [\[Link\]](#)
Ensure Shake [\[Link\]](#)

Aymes Actasolve Smoothie – vegan/milk free option [\[Link\]](#)

Third Line: For patients unable to make up powdered ONS

- **Ready to drink ONS**

Patients should be advised to fortify their food and have nutritious snacks and drinks. Guidance for this is available [here](#) and can be shared with patients or carers. Alongside this patients should be prescribed ready to drink ONS. **Recommended dose: 2 bottles per day.** Use links below to order sample packs.

Standard

Brands include:
Altraplen Energy [\[Link\]](#)
Aymes Complete [\[Link\]](#)
Ensure Plus Milkshake [\[Link\]](#)

Fortisip Plant Based – vegan/milk free option [\[Link\]](#)

Compact

For patients who struggle with volume or need fluid restriction

Brands include:
Altraplen Compact [\[Link\]](#)
Ensure Compact [\[Link\]](#)

Juice-style

For patients who do not like milk style drinks

Brands include:
Altrajuce [\[Link\]](#)
Ensure Plus Juce [\[Link\]](#)

Please note: Dietitian review prior to ONS prescribing (second & third line) may consist of an initial assessment for nutritional inadequacy, recommended ONS dosage and frequency, discontinuation date and any clinical threshold which would warrant re-referral.